

# PUEBLOAN CLIFF VILLAGE

Thousands of years ago, ancestors of the Indigenous people known as Puebloans began to settle in Mesa Verde in the southwest of the US. They were soon building villages, often in deep cliff alcoves which offered protection from the harsh climate. Now partly ruined, these still reveal how Puebloans once lived.



Corn comes in many colors. It can be made into flour when dried.



## Mesa Verde

The dramatic landscape of Mesa Verde spreads across the Colorado Plateau, in the state of Colorado, in the southwest of the US. It's near Four Corners, where four states meet: Colorado, Arizona, Utah, and New Mexico.



An eagle plume is tied into the dancer's hair.

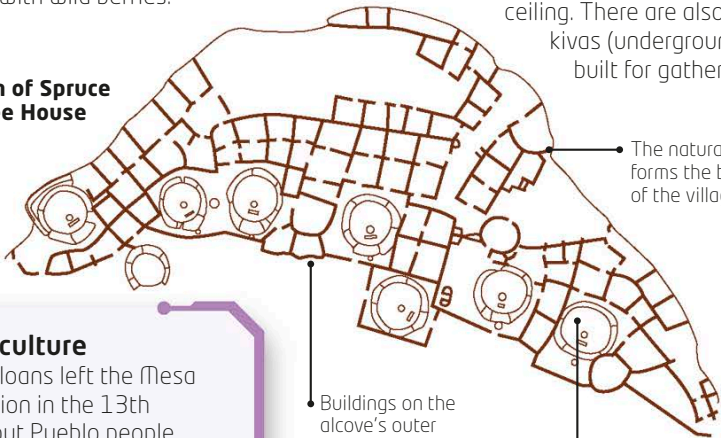
## Favorite foods

Puebloan people began settling and farming in the region sometime around 750 CE. They grew corn, squash, and beans in fields close to the villages. Meat from deer, rabbit, and (later) turkeys, was also on the menu, together with wild berries.

## 120-room accommodation

Spruce Tree House is one of the largest villages in the area. It has 120 rooms, many of which have two floors as well as a storage level just under the cliff ceiling. There are also eight kivas (underground rooms built for gatherings).

Plan of Spruce Tree House



The natural rock forms the back wall of the village.

Buildings on the alcove's outer edge overlook the ravine below.

Round plaza with kiva underneath

## Pueblo culture

The Puebloans left the Mesa Verde region in the 13th century, but Pueblo people, and their culture, are alive in Colorado, Arizona, and New Mexico. This young girl, dressed in traditional clothes and ornaments, is performing a ceremonial Kachina dance.

## Stolen remains

From the 19th century, a stream of people, from local cowboys to foreign explorers, became aware of the cliff villages. They treated the Puebloan dwellings disrespectfully, looting graves and shipping both human remains and artifacts off to museums in the US and abroad for money.

Sacred object, decorated with an eagle plume



Remains from a vandalized grave, displayed together with pots and other artifacts.